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CS 352

# TARGET AUDIENCE & USABILITY PROBLEM

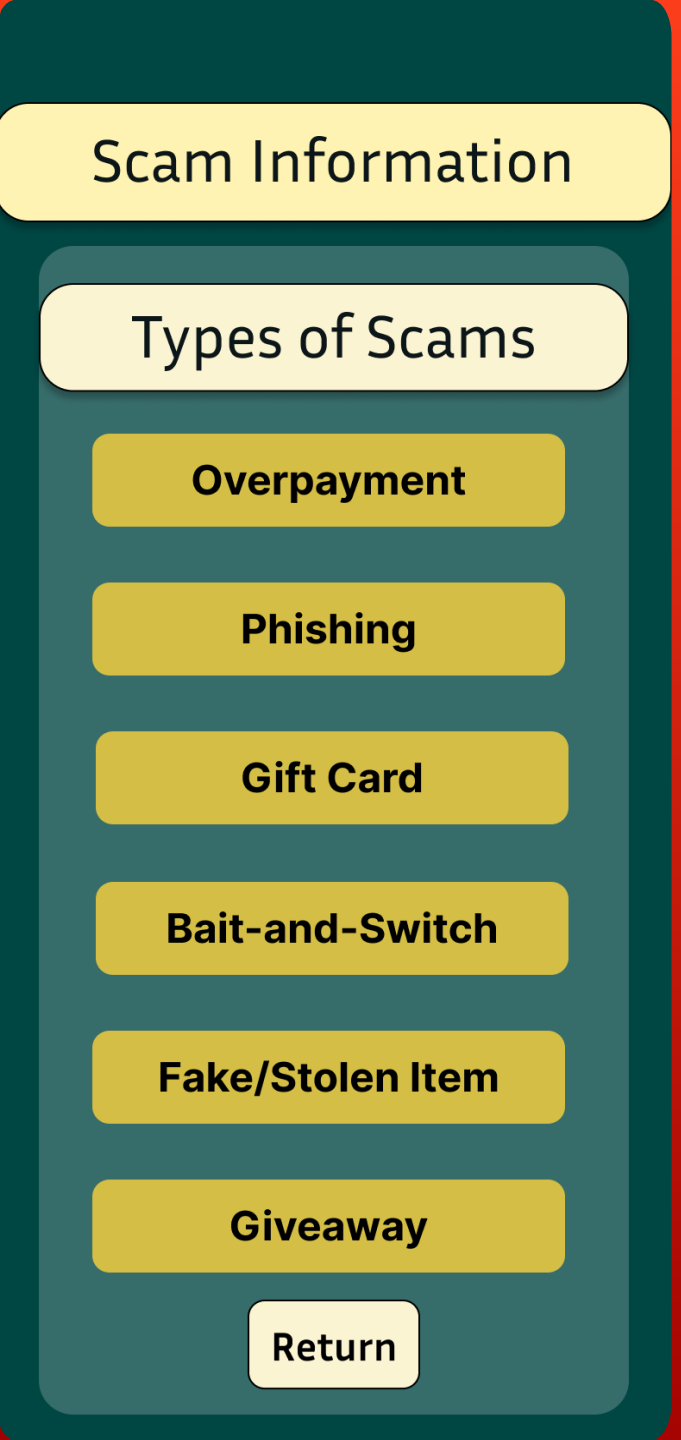
- Scamming and fraud on social media marketplaces have become quite significant in the past decade, to the point where it is an active concern for buyers and sellers. As such, my group's project is about creating an app to help facilitate safer transactions and fight scamming on social media marketplaces. Our target audience are people who use social media marketplaces for both buying and selling.

# INSIGHT 1: UNIFIED AND APPEALING VISUAL STYLE

- In these frames, our team aimed to maintain consistency with both the color scheme and the various elements. Elements intended to be headers, such as ‘Settings’ and ‘Light Mode’ span the entire length of the box. Meanwhile button elements, such as ‘Save’ and ‘Return’, do not. In addition, keeping colors consistent between frames was important, with the main header remaining a more yellowish color, while the subheaders being whiter. Both frames use the same dark color for the background and lighter color for the inner box

# INSIGHT 3: IDENTITY VERIFICATION

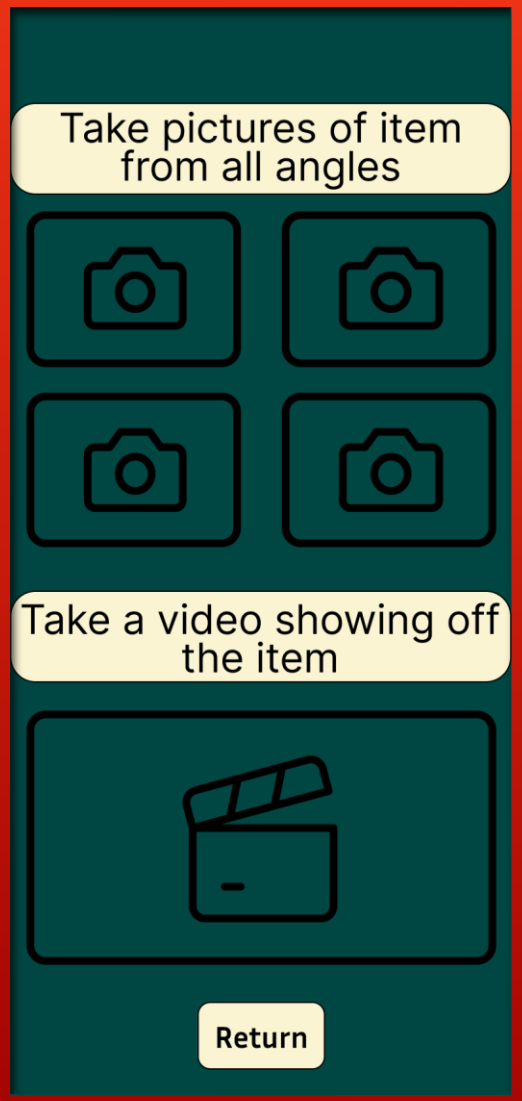
- The Identity Verification process is a critical feature of our app. In order to combat scammers easily creating multiple disposable accounts, our app requires that the user provide some form of government issues ID. The first frame explains what is done with the user's information once collected, as that was common questions asked by users during testing.




# INSIGHT 4: SCAM RESOURCES

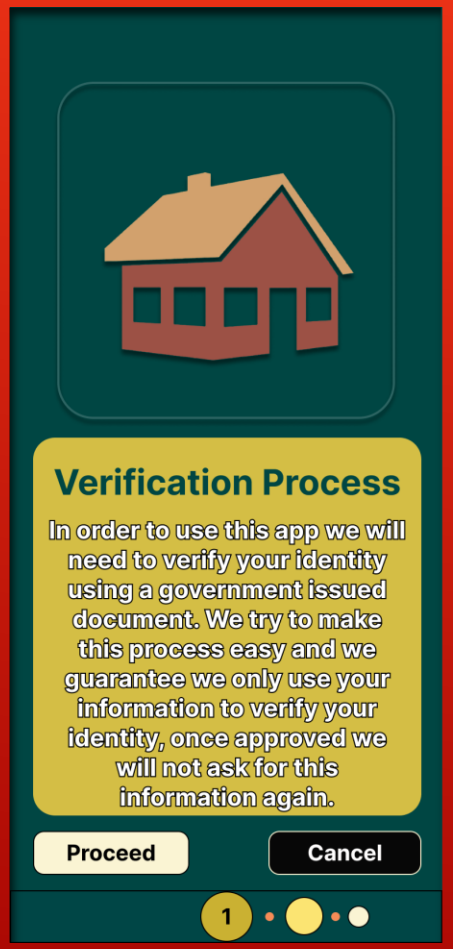
- During our research, we found that many people have difficulty identifying scams. To help combat this, we included a 'Scam Information' section that has a basic overview of six common types of scams found in social media marketplaces. Each frame has a basic explanation of each scam and how to best avoid it when using a social media marketplace.

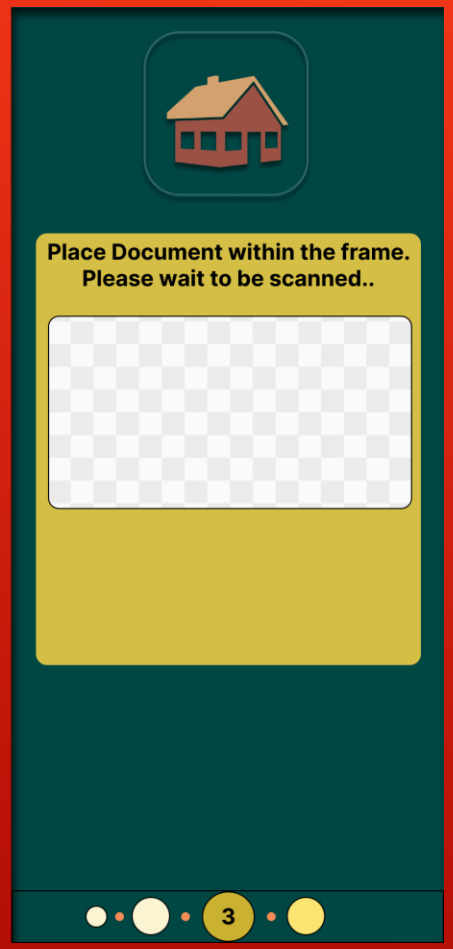
# INSIGHT 5: PICTURE VERIFICATION



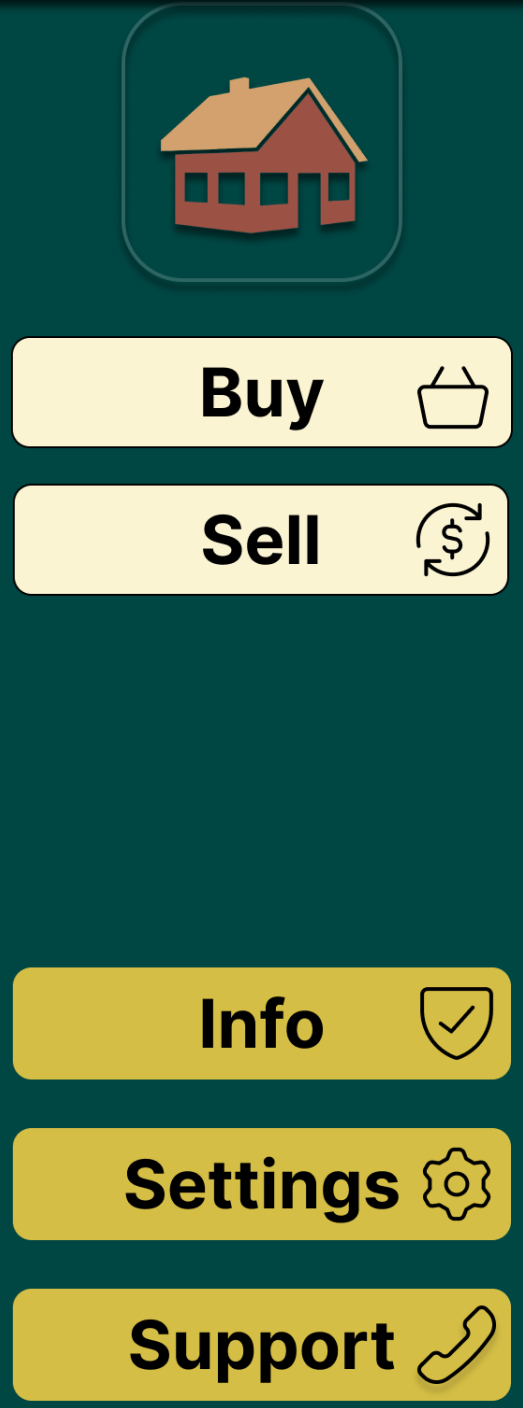
- Another critical component of the app is requiring sellers to have visual proof of the items they are selling. This is done by having them take both pictures and video in the app, to avoid them possibly using old pictures. We achieved this by creating a set of frames asking the seller to take pictures and video through the app. This insight was gathered from our research, were we found how common it is for scammers to use fake pictures when listing items for sale.

# INSIGHT 6: VERIFICATION STEP VISIBILITY



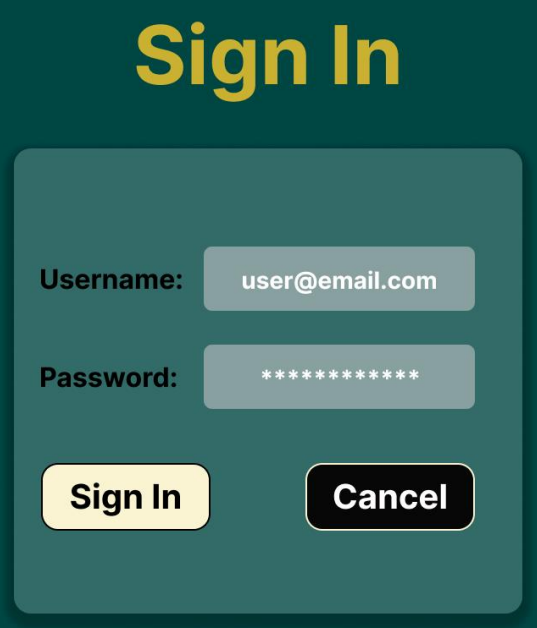



- This insight came from user feedback on our various prototypes. We found that users wished they knew what step of a given process they were on. Since verification is a multiple step process, we added a bar to bottom of the verification frames showing what step the user is currently on, and how many there are left to do.



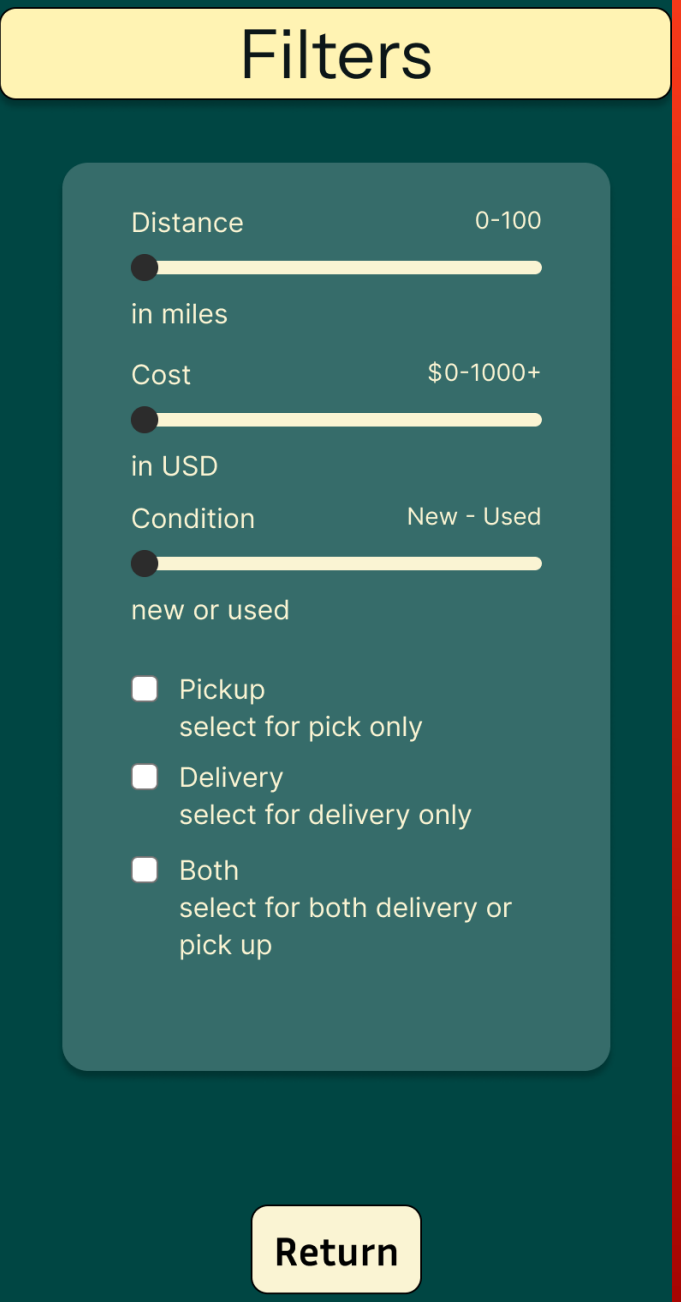

# UNIVERSAL DESIGN PRINCIPLE: SIMPLE AND INTUITIVE

- In this frame, the goal was to make sure users could distinguish the various options at a glance. As such, the main functions of the app, buying and selling, are at the top, while the utility functions, such as settings, are at the bottom, with both having different colors. We wanted to make sure the simple layout made it easy for user to navigate to each of apps different features.



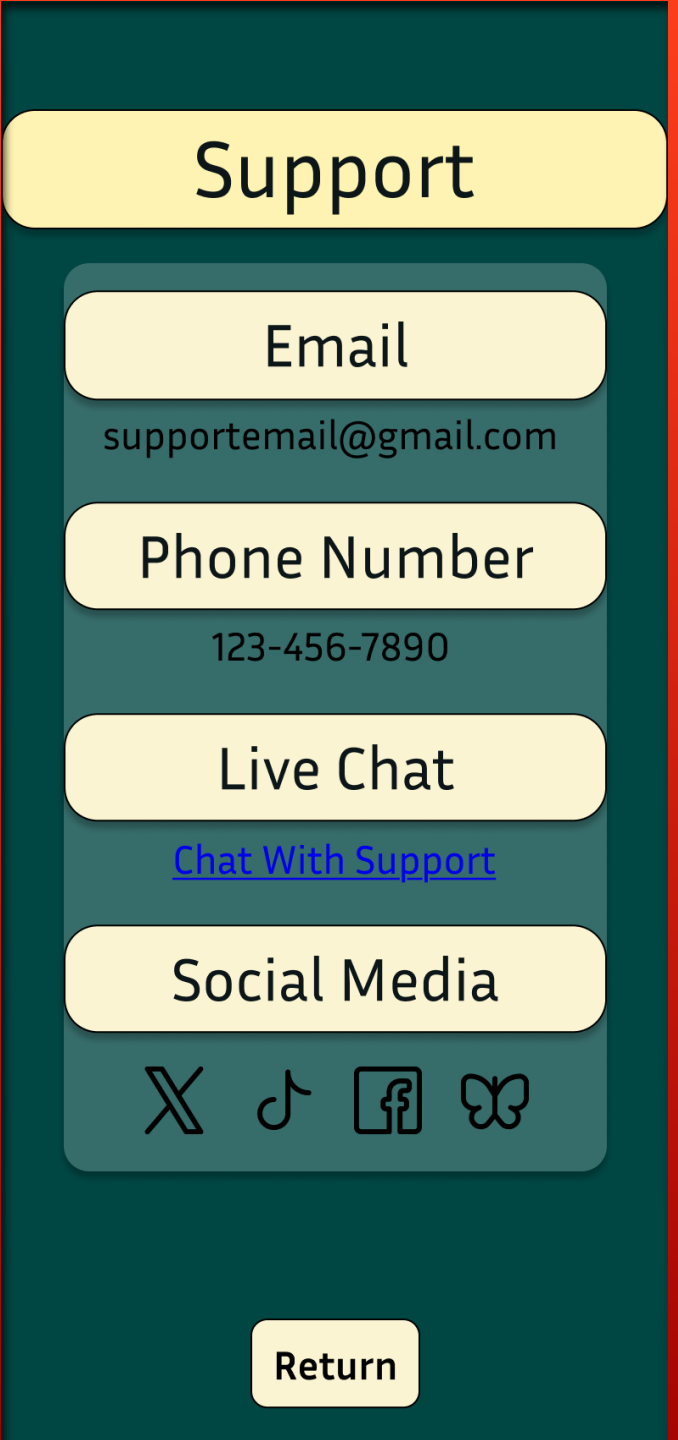

# HEURISTIC 2: MATCH BETWEEN THE SYSTEM AND THE REAL WORLD

- The first thing a user has to do when using our app is log in. We wanted to make sure the log in menu is as easy for users to understand and common to what you would see in any other app. As such, we went with a relatively simple and common layout, simply asking the user for their username and password.




# USABILITY HEURISTIC 8: AESTHETIC AND MINIMALIST DESIGN

- For this frame, we wanted to make sure the design for filtering was minimalistic and easy for users to understand the various options presented. The design is as minimal as possible, with the user being presented only few checkboxes and sliders. It was also necessary to provide the user with information on what each slider means.




# USABILITY HEURISTIC 10: HELP AND DOCUMENTATION

- Inspired from the 10th of Nielsen's usability heuristics, we wanted to include a frame that has some basic support information for users. We decided to include both an email and phone number for basic contact, along with a live chat feature for people that need interactive help. We also included links for the company's social media accounts, since most companies include such information.

# REFERENCES


Nielsen, J. (1994, April 24). *10 usability heuristics for user interface design*. Nielsen Norman Group. https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/

*The 7 principles*. Centre for Excellence in Universal Design. (n.d.). https://universaldesign.ie/about-universal-design/the-7-principles